Systems such as Biopipe (Hoon *et al.*, 2003), Taverna (Oinn *et al.*, 2004), Galaxy (Goecks *et al.*, 2010), GeneProf (Halbritter *et al.*, 2011) or PegaSys (Shah *et al.*, 2004) are easy to learn and use through their graphical user interface. Others such as Ruffus (Goodstadt, 2010), Pwrake (Tanaka and Tatebe, 2010), GXP Make (Taura *et al.*, 2010) and Bpipe (Sadedin *et al.*, 2012) use text-based definition of workflows, which can be advantageous: workflows can be edited without a graphical environment (e.g. directly on a remote server); and developers can collaborate on them through source code management tools. Similar to Pwrake and GXP Make, Snakemake is inspired by the build system GNU Make (Stallman and McGrath, 1991). They all infer the